Image cartoonized using vanceai.com

LUIS VON AHN

FOUNDER OF RECAPTCHA, CEO OF DUOLINGO

Von Ahn's first claim to fame was his role in developing CAPTCHAs, computer-generated tests that humans can pass but that computers cannot - for example, deciphering hard-to-read text or matching images. CAPTCHAs stop bots from perpetrating large-scale abuse on websites, such as buying huge amounts of tickets for resale by scalpers. Von Ahn, who was born and grew up in Guatemala City, is also the CEO of Duolingo, a language learning mobile app and website where users can learn over 30+ different languages. All of his work centers around his mission of building systems that "combine humans and computers to solve large-scale problems that neither can solve alone."

BOOTSTRAP
Equity • Scale • Rigor

This poster is brought to you by Bootstrap as part of our "Pioneers in Computing and Mathematics" poster library. FREE, research-driven, integrated Computer Science & Data Science modules for Math, Science, Business and Social Studies classes, grades 5-12 at BootstrapWorld.org.